CLAT: THE FINAL ROUND

The Final Test Series | Full-Length Mock 2 | 120 questions | 120 marks | 2 hours

INSTRUCTIONS TO CANDIDATES

Duration of the Test : 2 hours (120 minutes) **Maximum Marks :** 120

1. This Question Booklet (QB) contains 120 (One hundred and twenty) Multiple Choice Questions in five sections, followed by one page for rough work and a one-page answer key. No additional sheet of paper will be supplied for rough work.

2. You have to answer ALL questions. Every Right Answer secures 1 mark. Every Wrong Answer results in the deduction of 0.25 mark. There shall be no deduction for Unanswered Questions.

3. In the Legal Reasoning section, answer on the basis that the statements in each passage are the applicable law, even where they differ from the law in force. In the Quantitative Techniques section, answer from the data given in the passage; where the data does not permit an answer, 'Cannot be determined' is a valid choice.

4. No clarification can be sought on the QB from anyone. In case of any discrepancy such as a printing error or missing pages, request the Invigilator to replace the QB.

5. The use of any unfair means shall result in your disqualification. Possession of electronic devices, including mobile phones, headphones and digital watches, is strictly prohibited in the test premises.

CONTENTS OF THE QUESTION PAPER

Section	Question Numbers	Sets	Marks
English Language	1 - 24	6 passages	24
Current Affairs including General Knowledge	25 - 52	4 passages	28
Legal Reasoning	53 - 84	8 passages	32
Logical Reasoning	85 - 108	4 passages	24
Quantitative Techniques	109 - 120	3 sets	12
Total	**1 - 120**	**25 sets**	**120**

SUGGESTED TIME ALLOCATION

English Language	30 minutes	Current Affairs and GK	20 minutes
Legal Reasoning	30 minutes	Logical Reasoning	26 minutes
Quantitative Techniques	14 minutes	**Total**	**120 minutes**

DO NOT OPEN THIS BOOKLET UNTIL YOU ARE ASKED TO DO SO

Signature of the Candidate Signature of the Invigilator

ENGLISH LANGUAGE (Q. 1 - 24)

I. A memory that never lost anything would be a poor instrument for living. This is not the consolation of the forgetful; it is the finding of people who study people who cannot forget. Patients with near-total recall of their own lives describe the condition as an affliction rather than a gift, and the reason is not the volume of material but the absence of a filter. To remember every argument at its original temperature, every slight with its original wording, is to live in a present permanently overcrowded by the past.

What the research suggests is that forgetting is not the failure of a storage system but one of its operations. The mind does not simply lose material; it generalises from it, and generalising requires letting the particular go. A child who remembers every dog she has met has not learned what a dog is. The concept is built by discarding the differences between the encounters, which means that a good memory for principles depends on a poor memory for instances.

There is a second function, less discussed and more uncomfortable. Forgetting is how a person becomes able to act. An argument that is remembered in full is an argument that can be reopened; a grievance held at full resolution is a grievance that keeps its claim on the present. Societies that remember everything, or that insist on the full recall of everything, find it difficult to make the small accommodations that ordinary life requires. The amnesty, the statute of limitations, the decision not to press a point - each is a device for allowing the record to become less vivid without becoming false.

None of this argues for amnesia, and the distinction matters. There is a difference between a memory that has faded and a memory that has been overwritten, and the difference is not one of degree. A faded record can be returned to and disputed; a rewritten one cannot, because the evidence of the rewriting has been destroyed. The case for forgetting is a case for fading, and against the manufacture of a past that never happened.

[Written for this paper.]

1. The example of the child and the dogs is used to make which point?

(A) That children form concepts more quickly than adults do.
(B) That forming a general idea requires discarding the details of particular cases.
(C) That a memory for individual animals is of no use to a child.
(D) That the mind stores principles and instances in separate places.

2. Which of the following is supported by the passage?

(A) A person who recalls an injury in full detail finds it harder to set the injury aside.
(B) A person who has no recollection of an injury is best placed to forgive it.
(C) A person who recalls an injury vaguely is unable to judge whether it occurred.
(D) A person who recalls an injury in full detail finds it easier to set the injury aside.

3. The final paragraph is chiefly concerned to:

(A) qualify the argument by distinguishing two kinds of loss.
(B) concede that the argument has gone too far.
(C) summarise the evidence presented earlier in the passage.
(D) introduce a consideration that the author regards as irrelevant.

4. Which situation is most analogous to the process the author describes in the second paragraph?

(A) A librarian who replaces damaged books with new copies.
(B) A translator who renders a poem word for word into another language.
(C) A photographer who preserves each frame of a film without cutting.
(D) A cartographer who draws a map by omitting detail that does not affect the route.

II. The rain had been at it since Tuesday, and by Friday the lane had given up pretending to be a road. Bishu sat in the doorway of the goods shed with his legs stretched out and watched the water take the colour of the clay it was carrying. He had been night watchman at the depot for eleven years and had never once had to guard anything, which he regarded as proof that he was good at his job.

The shed at the far end, the one with the new lock, was the only part of the depot he had never been inside. The lock had been there since the previous March, when the survey party had come, stayed nine days, and left in a hurry. Whatever they had put in there, they had not put it in the register, and Bishu had decided some years ago that a man who asks about registers grows old in a job he does not have.

On Friday night the water reached the third step. At about two in the morning he heard, distinctly, the sound of something shifting inside the locked shed - not falling, shifting, the sound of weight being moved by someone who did not want to be heard doing it. He stood up. He took two steps towards the shed and then stopped, and what stopped him was not fear. It was the recollection, sudden and unwelcome, that the key had been given to him in an envelope eleven years ago and that he had never opened the envelope and had no idea where it was.

He went back to the doorway and sat down. In the morning the water had gone down and the shed was as it had been. He reported nothing, because there was nothing he could report that would not begin with the envelope, and the envelope would begin with eleven years. But for the rest of that season he sat facing the shed instead of the lane, and when the survey party came back in November he was at the gate before their jeep had stopped, and he asked them, in the voice of a man who has been waiting, what exactly they had left in his shed.

They said they had left nothing. They said the shed had been empty when they arrived and empty when they left, and they said this without hesitation, and Bishu, who had spent eleven years learning what hesitation sounds like, believed them, and went on sitting facing the shed.

[Written for this paper.]

5. Why does Bishu stop on his way to the shed?

(A) He remembers that the survey party is due to return.
(B) He is afraid of what he might find inside it.
(C) He realises that he cannot open it without admitting he never opened the envelope.
(D) He decides that the sound was made by the floodwater.

6. The detail that the survey party 'left in a hurry' functions in the story to:

(A) suggest something unexplained about what the shed contains.
(B) show that Bishu was not present at the time.
(C) explain why the register was not updated.
(D) establish that the depot is badly managed.

7. Bishu believes the survey party when they say the shed was always empty because:

(A) he had seen inside the shed himself.
(B) they produced the register to support the claim.
(C) he had no reason to distrust them before.
(D) they answered immediately and without hesitation.

8. The last sentence suggests that Bishu:

(A) concludes that the sound was caused by the flood.
(B) accepts the explanation and returns to his usual habits.
(C) remains unconvinced and continues to watch the shed.
(D) intends to report the survey party to his superiors.

III. Every few years someone announces that a new translation has finally given us the original, and every few years the announcement turns out to mean that the new version reads as though it had been written in the target language to begin with. This is offered as praise. It should be examined as a claim about what translation is for.

A translation that leaves no trace of having crossed a border is a translation that has made a decision on the reader's behalf: it has decided that the reader should not be troubled by the foreignness of the text. The decision is defensible where the foreignness is incidental - where the original's oddity is an artefact of its grammar rather than part of what it is doing. It is indefensible where the oddity is the point. A novel built out of a village dialect, a poem that keeps breaking its own metre, a memoir written in a language its author learned as an adult: smooth these and you have not preserved the work, you have preserved its plot.

The usual reply is that fidelity of this kind produces a text nobody wants to read, and that a translation unread is a translation that has failed more completely than an imperfect one. There is force in this. But the reply assumes that readers are fragile, and the evidence of what readers actually do with difficult books suggests otherwise. People read translated fiction precisely because it is translated; the unfamiliarity is part of the purchase. What they resist is not difficulty but the sense of being handled.

There is a practical consequence, and it is not aesthetic. If translations are judged by how little they show of the original, then the translator's most valuable skill becomes the ability to write like a novelist in the target language, and the ability to read the source with precision becomes secondary. That inversion has already happened in some markets, where the translator's name sells the book and the author's does not. A reader who wants the author's book, rather than a book about the author's book, should be suspicious of a translation that is too good.

[Written for this paper.]

9. The author's attitude to translations that read as though written in the target language is:

(A) hostility to the translators who produce them.
(B) approval, since readability is the translator's first duty.
(C) doubt, since such a translation can conceal what the original was doing.
(D) indifference, since the question is a matter of taste.

10. The examples in the second paragraph - the dialect novel, the broken metre, the late-learned language - are offered to show that:

(A) translators rarely understand the languages they translate from.
(B) readers prefer novels to poems in translation.
(C) some works resist translation.
(D) formal oddity can be part of a work's meaning rather than an obstacle to it.

11. The phrase 'the sense of being handled' refers to:

(A) the physical difficulty of holding a poorly produced book.
(B) the translator's interference with the author's intentions.
(C) the publisher's control over which books are translated.
(D) the reader's awareness that decisions have been taken on their behalf.

12. Which of the following, if true, would most weaken the author's practical argument in the last paragraph?

(A) Translators who read the source precisely also tend to write well in the target language.
(B) Readers in several markets buy books by translator rather than by author.
(C) Publishers pay translators less than authors receive in royalties.
(D) Some translated novels sell more copies than novels written originally in the same language.

IV. A stepwell is a building that has been turned inside out. Everything a palace puts on display - the storeys, the galleries, the carved brackets, the shade - a stepwell puts underground, and the deeper you go the cooler and more elaborate it becomes. The effect is of descending through a building rather than walking into one, and the descent is the architecture.

The water at the bottom was never the whole point. In the drier districts a stepwell was a piece of civil engineering with a ceremonial surface: it held the monsoon, it gave the village a place to gather, and it gave travellers a reason to stop. What it did not do, for most of its life, was function as a monument. That category arrived later, with the tourists and the conservation orders, and it arrived with a problem attached. A structure that is being used is maintained by the people who use it. A structure that is being admired is maintained by an office, and offices have budgets.

The restoration of these wells has therefore produced two kinds of result. Where the work was done so that the well could hold water again, the repairs have tended to be coarse - new concrete where there was lime, straight edges where there were curves - and the well has continued to be a well. Where the work was done so that the well could be photographed, the surfaces are beautiful and the well is dry, because the first thing a photograph requires is that the water be clear of the things that make water useful.

There is no way to have both, and the argument for choosing is not an argument about beauty. A well that holds water keeps the craft that built it alive in the only way craft survives, which is by being needed. A well that holds nothing but admiration keeps the craft alive as a set of photographs in an archive. The choice, in other words, is between two kinds of continuity, and only one of them involves anybody getting their feet wet.

[Written for this paper.]

13. The comparison with a palace in the first paragraph is used to:

(A) show that both were designed by the same guild of builders.
(B) suggest that stepwells were built for rulers rather than villagers.

(C) explain the structure by inverting the reader's expectation of where architectural display is found.
(D) argue that stepwells are more accomplished buildings than palaces.

14. The author's objection to treating stepwells as monuments is that:
(A) conservation orders prevent any repair from being carried out.
(B) monuments are photographically less interesting than working wells.
(C) monuments attract too many visitors.
(D) the change from use to admiration transfers maintenance from users to an office with a budget.

15. Which of the following best captures the author's position on restoration?
(A) Restoration should not be attempted where the original craft is lost.
(B) Coarse repairs should be rejected because they damage the fabric of the building.
(C) Coarse repairs may be acceptable where they keep the structure in use.
(D) Restoration should aim at the appearance the building had when new.

16. The last sentence implies that:
(A) craft survives mainly through archives and photographs.
(B) the two forms of continuity are unequal because only one keeps the practice in use.
(C) neither form of continuity is worth preserving.
(D) conservation offices should be given larger budgets.

V. The case for the universal museum rests on a claim about access: that objects gathered in one place can be seen by more people, studied by more scholars, and protected by better laboratories than they could be in the places they came from. The claim is true often enough to be worth answering, and false often enough to be worth answering carefully.

The first difficulty is that access is being counted in the wrong currency. A visitor passing a vitrine in ninety seconds is not the same kind of access as a community that uses an object in an annual ceremony, and a museum that reports its visitor numbers has not measured the second at all. The second difficulty is that the claim assumes the object would otherwise be in a place with no laboratory, which is a statement about the present rather than about the conditions under which the object left. The third is the one that curators rarely address in public: a collection assembled under conditions that would now be unlawful is not made legitimate by the quality of the building it is now kept in.

None of this settles the question, because the question is not one question. There is a difference between an object taken in a punitive expedition and an object bought from a dealer whose title was doubtful, and there is a difference between a claim for return made by a state and a claim made by a community that the state does not represent. Treating these as one demand produces the two positions that dominate the argument - return everything, return nothing - and both are positions that no serious institution holds.

What is achievable is duller and harder: a register of how each contested object left, published; a presumption that where the record is missing the claim for return is stronger rather than weaker; and arrangements in which ownership and custody can be separated, so that a community can hold title to an object that remains, for reasons of conservation, in a building it did not build.

[Written for this paper.]

17. Which of the following best states the author's view?
(A) The claim about access is true and settles the argument in the museum's favour.
(B) The claim about access cannot be assessed without knowing the object's value.
(C) The universal museum's claim about access is false and should be abandoned.
(D) The claim about access is sometimes true but does not answer the question being asked.

18. The author's objection to counting visitor numbers as access is that:
(A) visitor numbers overstate the audience that museums reach.
(B) a brief encounter and a continuing use of an object are different kinds of access, and only one is measured.
(C) communities that use objects do not visit museums.
(D) scholars have better access than visitors do.

19. The two positions the author says dominate the argument - return everything and return nothing - are presented as:
(A) products of treating dissimilar claims as a single demand.
(B) positions held by serious institutions but not by the public.

(C) positions that the author must consider equally well supported.
(D) the positions that can be defended consistently.

20. The measures proposed in the final paragraph depend on the assumption that:
(A) communities prefer ownership to custody as a rule.
(B) conservation requirements are the same across countries.
(C) museums must accept that their collections are unlawful.
(D) records of how objects left their places of origin can be assembled and made public.

VI. My teacher taught me for eleven years and never once told me I was doing well. This was not cruelty; it was a method, and the method had a logic I understood only after I stopped being taught. Praise, he said, is what a listener gives. A student who is given praise learns to play for the listener. A student who is given only the next correction learns to play for the thing being corrected, which is the music.

The first hour of every lesson was the same. He would sit with his eyes closed and his hand marking time, and I would sing the same composition I had sung the week before, and at some point he would raise a finger and we would spend forty minutes on four notes. Not on the composition, not on the ornament, not on the emotion - on four notes, until the fourth one stopped being a note I was producing and became a note that arrived. I could not have explained the difference then. I can explain it now only by saying that the note stopped being an event and became a place.

There is a version of this that sounds like mysticism, and it is worth resisting. What was actually happening was ordinary and physical: my breath was being trained, my ear was being trained, and the training was being done by repetition under supervision rather than by explanation. The reason he did not explain is not that explanation is useless. It is that explanation is cheap, and a student who has been given an explanation can believe he has learned the thing. The correction cannot be believed; it can only be done.

I have since taught, badly, and I recognise the temptation. It is much easier to describe the destination than to sit with someone for forty minutes while they fail to arrive. The method also has a cost that my teacher never mentioned, and that I discovered in the years when I did not play at all: a training built entirely on correction leaves a student with no vocabulary for pleasure. I could hear every fault in my own playing for a decade before I could hear anything else in it. That, too, was the method, and it was not free.

[Written for this paper.]

21. The teacher's refusal to praise is explained in the passage as:
(A) a belief that praise is dishonest.
(B) a personal preference for silence.
(C) a method intended to direct the student's attention to the music rather than the listener.
(D) a way of testing whether the student would continue.

22. The distinction between a note that is 'an event' and a note that is 'a place' is used to describe:
(A) the point at which the student begins to enjoy performing.
(B) the difference between a note played loudly and one played softly.
(C) a change in the student's relation to the note produced by repetition under supervision.
(D) the difference between singing and playing an instrument.

23. The author's attitude towards his teacher's method is best described as:
(A) neutral, since the passage reports rather than evaluates.
(B) grateful, and free of reservation.
(C) critical, and dismissive of its results.
(D) appreciative of its logic while acknowledging a cost it did not disclose.

24. Which of the following is the strongest objection to the teacher's practice of not explaining?
(A) Students who are not praised may stop attending lessons.
(B) Some compositions are too difficult to be taught by correction alone.
(C) Some students learn more quickly when a technique is described before it is practised.
(D) Explanation takes less time than repetition and is therefore cheaper to give.

CURRENT AFFAIRS INCLUDING GENERAL KNOWLEDGE (Q. 25 - 52)

VII. The XXV Olympic Winter Games were held in Milan and Cortina d'Ampezzo in northern Italy from 6 to 22 February 2026, with competition spread across venues in the two cities and the surrounding valleys, and the closing ceremony held in the Verona Olympic Arena, a Roman amphitheatre in a city that hosted no sporting events. Ninety-two nations took part in 116 medal events.

Norway topped the medal table for the fourth successive Winter Games, with 18 golds and 41 medals in all, both records. Johannes Hoesflot Klaebo won six gold medals in cross-country skiing, the most by any athlete at a single Winter Games, and his sixth, in the men's 50 km mass start, was the last medal awarded at the Games. The United States finished second with 12 golds and 33 medals, and Italy, the host, had its best Winter Games with 10 golds among 30 medals, finishing fourth. Great Britain won five medals, three of them gold, its best return at a Winter Games.

The Games were the first Winter Olympics to be held across two host cities, and the first at which the hosts were chosen together with the host of the Summer Games of 2026's cycle, a change made to give organising committees more time. India was represented by a small contingent, as in previous Winter Games, and did not win a medal.

25. Which country topped the medal table at the 2026 Winter Olympics?

(A) Norway
(B) Germany
(C) Italy
(D) United States

26. The closing ceremony of the 2026 Winter Olympics was held in:

(A) Cortina d'Ampezzo
(B) Turin
(C) Verona
(D) Milan

27. The performance of Johannes Hoesflot Klaebo at the 2026 Games is notable because:

(A) he won the first medal awarded at the Games.
(B) he won medals in three different sports.
(C) his six golds were the most by any athlete at a single Winter Games.
(D) he was the oldest medallist at the Games.

28. The first Olympic Winter Games were held in 1924 in:

(A) St Moritz, Switzerland
(B) Lake Placid, United States
(C) Oslo, Norway
(D) Chamonix, France

29. Which of the following is correct about the 2026 Winter Games as described in the passage?

(A) They were the only Winter Games with more than a hundred nations.
(B) They were the first Winter Games held in Italy.
(C) They were the first Winter Games held across two host cities.
(D) They were the first Winter Games at which India won a medal.

30. The host city of the 2030 Winter Olympic Games is:

(A) Salt Lake City, United States
(B) the French Alps
(C) Calgary, Canada
(D) Sapporo, Japan

31. Italy's result at the 2026 Games is described as its best Winter Games because it won:

(A) gold in both the men's and women's downhill events.
(B) ten golds among thirty medals, finishing fourth.
(C) more medals than the United States.
(D) the last medal of the Games.

VIII. The 57th meeting of the Goods and Services Tax Council was held in New Delhi on 8 October 2026 under the chairpersonship of the Union Finance Minister. The Council left the rate structure unchanged and concentrated on process reform, describing the decisions as moving from rate rationalisation, which had been the focus of the previous meeting, to the working of the tax day to day.

The most significant recommendation was the withdrawal of the power to arrest under the GST law, by omission of section 69 of the CGST Act, 2017. Alongside this, the monetary threshold for launching prosecution was raised from one crore rupees to five crore rupees, the general penalty was reduced from twenty-five thousand rupees to ten thousand rupees, and it was decided that no notice would be issued where the tax involved was ten thousand rupees or less, with pending notices below that threshold to be withdrawn. Punishment was changed from imprisonment and fine to imprisonment or fine or both, and the minimum imprisonment of six months was removed, leaving the quantum to the court's discretion.

Other measures included a reduction in the time for acknowledging refund claims from fifteen days to ten days, permission for employers to claim input tax credit on GST paid for employee insurance, simpler registration for small sellers on e-commerce platforms, and a ceiling of forty crore rupees on the pre-deposit required to appeal where an order imposes only a penalty. The Council also said that changes to rates would be considered once a year.

32. Which of the following was recommended at the 57th meeting of the GST Council?

(A) The withdrawal of the power to arrest under the GST law.
(B) An increase in the general penalty.
(C) The merger of the CGST and SGST laws.
(D) A reduction in the number of GST slabs, which the Council must adopt in the same year.

33. The monetary threshold for launching prosecution under GST was raised to:

(A) Two crore rupees
(B) Five crore rupees
(C) Ten crore rupees
(D) One crore rupees

34. The GST Council is constituted under which provision of the Constitution?

(A) Article 280
(B) Article 246A
(C) Article 269A
(D) Article 279A

35. Which of the following best describes the Council's approach at this meeting, as reported in the passage?

(A) It left the rate structure unchanged and focused on compliance and process.
(B) It transferred the power to fix rates to the States.
(C) It abolished the requirement of registration for small businesses.
(D) It reduced rates on several categories of goods.

36. An order imposes only a penalty and no demand of tax. Under the recommendations described, the pre-deposit required to appeal is capped at:

(A) Fifty crore rupees
(B) Ten crore rupees
(C) Twenty crore rupees
(D) Forty crore rupees

37. GST was brought into force in India on:

(A) 1 April 2016
(B) 1 July 2017
(C) 1 January 2018
(D) 1 April 2019

38. The change from 'imprisonment and fine' to 'imprisonment or fine or both', together with the removal of the minimum term, has the effect of:

(A) transferring sentencing power to the GST Council.
(B) making conviction more likely while lightening punishment.

(C) leaving the choice of punishment to the court's discretion.
(D) removing the possibility of imprisonment for tax offences.

IX. The Convention for the Safeguarding of the Intangible Cultural Heritage, adopted by UNESCO in 2003, maintains two lists: the Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity, and the List of Intangible Cultural Heritage in Need of Urgent Safeguarding. Inscription does not confer ownership; it recognises a practice, and it obliges the State concerned to draw up measures to safeguard it, with the participation of the communities that keep it alive.

Garba of Gujarat was inscribed on the Representative List in 2023, at the eighteenth session of the Intergovernmental Committee held in Kasane, Botswana, and was at that point India's fifteenth inscription on the List. Garba is a ritualistic and devotional dance performed during Navaratri, in which dancers move in a circle around a perforated earthenware pot lit with an oil lamp, or an image of the goddess, clapping and singing as the tempo rises.

India's inscriptions include the tradition of Vedic chanting, Kutiyattam, Ramlila, Chhau dance, the Buddhist chanting of Ladakh, Yoga, the Kumbh Mela, Durga Puja in Kolkata and Deepavali, which was inscribed in 2025. A multinational nomination on henna, submitted by seventeen countries including India, was listed for examination at the Committee's twenty-first session, due in November and December 2026.

39. In which year was Garba of Gujarat inscribed on the Representative List?
(A) 2025
(B) 2021
(C) 2022
(D) 2023

40. Which of the following is correct about inscription on the Representative List?
(A) It transfers ownership of the practice to UNESCO.
(B) It recognises a practice and obliges the State to safeguard it with community participation.
(C) It requires the practice to be removed from national inventories.
(D) It is confined to practices in danger of disappearing.

41. The Garba described in the passage is performed around:
(A) an idol carried in procession through the streets.
(B) a painted image of the sun.
(C) a fire lit at the centre of a courtyard.
(D) a perforated earthenware pot lit with an oil lamp.

42. The UNESCO Convention dealt with in the passage was adopted in:
(A) 1989
(B) 2003
(C) 2011
(D) 1972

43. Which of the following Indian inscriptions is correctly paired with the year given in the passage?
(A) Chhau dance - 2021
(B) Kumbh Mela - 2012
(C) Kutiyattam - 2010
(D) Yoga - 2016

44. The henna nomination referred to in the passage is described as multinational because:
(A) it was examined in more than one session of the Committee.
(B) it was submitted jointly by UNESCO and India.
(C) it was submitted by seventeen countries, including India.
(D) it concerns a practice found on three continents only.

45. The body that examines nominations for inscription under the Convention is the:
(A) Intergovernmental Committee for the Safeguarding of the Intangible Cultural Heritage
(B) General Conference of UNESCO
(C) Executive Board of UNESCO
(D) World Heritage Committee

X. Spain won the 2026 FIFA World Cup, beating Argentina 1-0 after extra time in the final played at the New York New Jersey Stadium on 19 July 2026. The only goal came in the 106th minute from the substitute Ferran Torres, and Spain became world champions for the second time, having first won in 2010. Argentina played the closing stages with ten men after Enzo Fernandez was sent off in stoppage time at the end of the ninety minutes.

The tournament was the first to be held across three countries - the United States, Canada and Mexico - and the first in the expanded format of forty-eight teams, playing 104 matches rather than the 64 of the previous edition. Luis de la Fuente, Spain's coach, became the oldest coach to win the World Cup, at the age of 65. The attendance at the final was 80,663.

Spain's win was built on possession and pressing rather than a single scorer: they outshot Argentina heavily across the match, and the winning goal came from a side that had been criticised during the tournament for a lack of a recognised centre-forward. For Argentina, the defeat ended a campaign in which Lionel Messi, playing in his sixth World Cup, had been the central figure.

46. Who scored the winning goal in the 2026 World Cup final?

(A) Alvaro Morata
(B) Nico Williams
(C) Ferran Torres
(D) Lamine Yamal

47. The 2026 World Cup was the first to be:

(A) hosted by three countries and played by forty-eight teams.
(B) decided by a penalty shoot-out in the final.
(C) hosted in North America.
(D) held in the southern hemisphere in winter.

48. Spain's previous World Cup victory came in:

(A) 2014
(B) 2018
(C) 2006
(D) 2010

49. Luis de la Fuente's achievement at the 2026 tournament was that he:

(A) became the oldest coach to win the World Cup, at 65.
(B) won the tournament as both player and coach.
(C) managed a team that did not concede a goal.
(D) became the youngest coach to win the World Cup.

50. Argentina finished the final with ten men because:

(A) their captain was substituted after an injury.
(B) Enzo Fernandez was sent off in stoppage time at the end of ninety minutes.
(C) a player was withdrawn for a concussion check.
(D) they used all their permitted substitutions.

51. The number of matches played at the 2026 World Cup, compared with the previous edition, was:

(A) the same
(B) 64 rather than 104
(C) 104 rather than 64
(D) 128 rather than 104

52. Which country has won the most FIFA World Cup titles?

(A) Brazil
(B) Germany
(C) Italy
(D) Argentina

LEGAL REASONING (Q. 53 - 84)

XI. The Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code, 2016 allows a financial creditor to initiate the corporate insolvency resolution process (the "CIRP") by filing an application before the Adjudicating Authority where a corporate debtor has defaulted in payment of a debt of at least one crore rupees. An operational creditor, such as a supplier of goods, must first deliver a demand notice and wait ten days before filing. Where an application is admitted, the Authority declares a moratorium under which no suit or proceeding for recovery may be instituted or continued, no security interest may be enforced, and the corporate debtor may not transfer or dispose of its assets.

On admission, the management of the corporate debtor passes to a resolution professional, and the powers of the board of directors are suspended. A committee of creditors, in which financial creditors vote in proportion to the debt owed, decides by a vote of not less than sixty-six per cent whether to accept a resolution plan. A creditor who has been convicted of a specified offence, or who is a promoter of a company whose account has been classified as a non-performing asset for more than a year, is not eligible to submit a resolution plan.

A creditor in whose favour the corporate debtor has transferred property at a undervalue within the preceding two years may be required to return the benefit to the corporate debtor. The process is to be completed within three hundred and thirty days, including any extension granted by the Authority.

53. A supplier of steel is owed two crore rupees by a manufacturing company and has not been paid for eight months. Which of the following is correct?

(A) The right to apply is confined to financial creditors, so the supplier is outside the provision.

(B) The supplier's remedy lies in a decree of a civil court, after which an application may follow.

(C) The supplier must be treated as a financial creditor, since the amount exceeds one crore rupees.

(D) The supplier must first deliver a demand notice and wait ten days before filing.

54. After admission of an application against a company, a bank that holds a mortgage over the company's factory wishes to enforce it. Which of the following is correct?

(A) The bank may enforce the mortgage, since its security is unaffected by the process.

(B) The bank may enforce the mortgage with the consent of the resolution professional.

(C) The bank may not enforce the mortgage during the moratorium.

(D) The bank's enforcement follows a decision of the committee of creditors.

55. A resolution plan is supported by creditors holding sixty per cent of the debt and opposed by the rest. Which of the following is correct?

(A) The plan is not accepted, since unanimous consent of all creditors is required.

(B) The plan is accepted, since a simple majority of creditors by value supports it.

(C) The plan is not accepted, since it requires not less than sixty-six per cent of the vote.

(D) The plan is accepted if the Adjudicating Authority approves it regardless of the vote.

56. A promoter of the corporate debtor wishes to submit a resolution plan for the company. Which of the following facts would disqualify him under the passage?

(A) He holds fifteen per cent of the shares of the corporate debtor.

(B) The account of another company of which he is a promoter has been classified as a non-performing asset for two years.

(C) He was a director of the corporate debtor until the application was admitted.

(D) He has offered a plan that repays creditors less than they are owed.

XII. The Protection of Women from Domestic Violence Act, 2005 protects a woman who is or has been in a domestic relationship with the respondent, which includes a relationship by consanguinity, marriage or adoption, a relationship in the nature of marriage, and a joint family relationship. "Domestic violence" includes physical, sexual, verbal and emotional abuse, and economic abuse, which covers deprivation of financial resources and the disposal of household assets to the disadvantage of the aggrieved person.

"Shared household" means a household in which the aggrieved person lives or has at any stage lived in a domestic relationship, whether or not she has any right, title or interest in it. On an application, a Magistrate may pass a residence order restraining the respondent from dispossessing the aggrieved person or otherwise disturbing her possession of the shared household, and may direct the respondent to provide an alternative accommodation where the shared household cannot be continued.

The Magistrate may also order monetary relief towards maintenance, and compensation for injuries including mental torture and emotional distress. Proceedings may be initiated by the aggrieved person herself, or by a protection officer or any other person on her behalf, and the Magistrate is to dispose of an application within sixty days of its first hearing.

57. A woman lives with her husband in a house owned by her mother-in-law, who wishes to evict her. Which of the following is correct?

(A) A residence order runs against the husband, the mother-in-law being outside its reach.

(B) A residence order must be refused, since the woman has no right or title in the house.

(C) A residence order may be passed, since the house is her shared household regardless of title.

(D) A residence order depends on the husband holding title to the house.

58. A husband stops paying the household electricity bills and sells his wife's jewellery to fund a business of his own. Which of the following is the most accurate description?

(A) Neither act is actionable unless the wife can show she paid for the jewellery.

(B) These acts are not covered, since no physical violence has occurred.

(C) The sale of the jewellery is economic abuse, and the deprivation of funds may also be economic abuse.

(D) Only the sale of the jewellery is actionable, since bills are household expenses.

59. The wife's sister, who lives in the same household and is also subjected to abuse by the same respondent, wishes to apply. Which of the following is correct?

(A) She may not apply, since she is not the respondent's wife.

(B) Her application depends on the wife joining as a co-applicant.

(C) Her claim is confined to compensation, a residence order not being available to her.

(D) She may apply, since a relationship by consanguinity is a domestic relationship.

60. An application is filed on 1 March and the Magistrate has not disposed of it by 15 May. Which of the following is correct?

(A) The application does not lapse, since the sixty-day period is a direction to the Magistrate to dispose of it within that time.

(B) The application lapses unless the aggrieved person files a fresh application.

(C) The application is to be transferred to a higher court.

(D) The application lapses, since the period of sixty days has expired.

XIII. The Rights of Persons with Disabilities Act, 2016 defines "reasonable accommodation" as the necessary and appropriate modification and adjustment, without imposing a disproportionate or undue burden, needed to ensure that a person with a disability enjoys rights equally with others. Discrimination under the Act includes denying a person reasonable accommodation, and the burden of showing that an accommodation would impose a disproportionate burden lies on the establishment that refuses it.

Every establishment is required to frame an equal opportunity policy, to appoint a liaison officer where it employs twenty or more persons, and to provide, in government establishments, not less than four per cent reservation in posts identified as suitable for persons with benchmark disabilities. An establishment may not reduce the rank or pay of an employee who acquires a disability during service, and must make an alternative posting where the employee can no longer perform the original duties.

The Act recognises twenty-one specified disabilities, and a person is a "person with benchmark disability" where the disability is not less than forty per cent of a specified condition, certified by a certifying authority.

61. An employer refuses a request from a wheelchair-using employee for a ground-floor desk, saying that rearrangement would inconvenience other staff. Which of the following is the most accurate statement?

(A) The refusal may amount to discrimination, and the employer must show that the accommodation would impose a disproportionate burden.

(B) The refusal is justified if other employees object to being moved.

(C) The obligation to comply arises where the employee holds a benchmark disability certificate.

(D) The employer has not discriminated, since the request is a matter of convenience.

62. An employee who has worked for nine years loses her vision and can no longer perform her original role. Which of the following is correct?

(A) The employer must terminate her service on grounds of incapacity.

(B) The employer must retain her and make an alternative posting, without reducing her rank or pay.

(C) The employer may reduce her pay to reflect the reduced duties.

(D) Retention depends on her obtaining a fresh appointment.

63. An establishment employing thirty-five persons has framed an equal opportunity policy but has appointed no liaison officer. Which of the following is correct?

(A) There is a default, since a liaison officer is required where twenty or more persons are employed.

(B) There is no default, since the obligation arises at fifty or more employees.

(C) A default arises if the establishment also fails to provide reservation.

(D) There is no default, since the liaison officer requirement is confined to government establishments.

64. A candidate is certified as having a specified disability assessed at thirty-five per cent. Which of the following is correct?

(A) The candidate's status depends on whether the post is identified as suitable.

(B) The candidate's status depends on certification by a government establishment.

(C) The candidate is a person with benchmark disability, since any specified disability qualifies.

(D) The candidate is not a person with benchmark disability, since the threshold is forty per cent.

XIV. Under the Indian Contract Act, 1872, consent is free when it is not caused by coercion, undue influence, fraud, misrepresentation or mistake. Coercion is the committing or threatening of any act forbidden by the Penal Code, or the unlawful detaining of property, to cause a person to enter into an agreement. Undue influence arises where the relations between the parties are such that one is in a position to dominate the will of the other and uses that position to obtain an unfair advantage.

A contract whose consent is caused by coercion, undue influence or fraud is voidable at the option of the party whose consent was so caused. Where consent is caused by undue influence, the court may set aside the contract either absolutely or upon such terms as appear just, and may require the party benefiting from it to return the benefit received. A person who is not of the age of majority is not competent to contract, and an agreement with such a person is void.

Where a person signs a document without knowing its contents, and the document is of a kind that a reasonable person would not sign without inquiry, the burden of proving that the signer understood it lies on the person seeking to enforce it.

65. An employer tells a domestic worker that her brother, who works in the same household, will be dismissed unless she signs a sale deed transferring her land at a quarter of its value. Which of the following is the most accurate statement?

(A) The deed is voidable at the worker's option, since her consent was caused by coercion.

(B) The deed is valid, since the worker signed it voluntarily.

(C) The deed is voidable on proof that the employer intended to carry out the threat.

(D) The deed is void, since the price was inadequate.

66. A moneylender who has lent to a villager for years takes a mortgage over the villager's entire holding for a further small loan on terms that leave the villager with no means of repayment. Which of the following is the most accurate statement?

(A) The transaction is valid, since the villager approached the moneylender.

(B) The transaction may be set aside on the ground of undue influence, since the relationship allowed the moneylender to dominate the villager's will.

(C) The transaction is void, since interest was charged.

(D) The transaction may be set aside on proof of physical force.

67. A seventeen-year-old signs an agreement to purchase a motorcycle on credit. Which of the following is correct?

(A) The agreement is voidable at the minor's option.

(B) The agreement is void, since a person below the age of majority is not competent to contract.

(C) The agreement is valid if the minor's guardian approves it later.

(D) The agreement is enforceable if the minor has paid part of the price.

68. An elderly widow signs a document in a language she cannot read, which turns out to be a gift of her house to a neighbour. The neighbour sues to enforce it. Which of the following is correct?

(A) The burden lies on the widow, since she signed the document.

(B) The document is void, since a gift of a house requires registration.

(C) The document is enforceable, since a signature is conclusive of consent.

(D) The burden of proving that she understood the document lies on the neighbour.

XV. A lease of immovable property is a transfer of a right to enjoy that property, made for a certain time, expressed or implied, in consideration of a price paid or promised, on the terms set out in the transfer. A licence, by contrast, is a permission to do something on the property which, in the absence of that permission, would be unlawful, and it does not create an interest in the property.

The distinction turns on possession. A lessee obtains exclusive possession and may exclude others, including the owner, except as the lease allows; a licensee obtains a permission that is personal and generally revocable. Where a person occupies premises under an arrangement that gives exclusive possession for a defined period at a periodic payment, the arrangement is treated as a lease whatever the parties call it, because the substance of the transaction, and not its label, determines its character.

A lease of immovable property from month to month may be terminated by a notice to quit of fifteen days, and a lease from year to year by a notice of six months, unless the lease provides otherwise. A licence may be revoked at any time on reasonable notice, and revocation does not entitle the licensee to compensation except for expenses incurred on a promise of continuance.

69. A company occupies a floor of a building under a document headed 'Licence Agreement', pays a monthly sum, holds the only key to the floor, and has excluded the owner from it for four years. Which of the following is the most accurate statement?

(A) The arrangement is a lease, since exclusive possession for a defined period at a periodic payment is the substance of a lease.

(B) The arrangement is a licence, since no deed of lease was executed.

(C) The arrangement is neither, since the parties have misdescribed it.

(D) The arrangement is a licence, since the document says so.

70. A monthly tenant wishes to leave, and the landlord wishes to end the tenancy. Which of the following is correct under the passage?

(A) The power to terminate rests with the landlord.

(B) The tenancy may be terminated without notice where rent is paid monthly.

(C) Either party may terminate by fifteen days' notice, unless the lease provides otherwise.

(D) Either party may terminate on six months' notice, whatever the term of the tenancy.

71. A licensee who has spent money renovating a shop at the owner's request is asked to leave. Which of the following is correct?

(A) The licensee may claim the value of the renovation as a matter of course.

(B) The licence may be revoked on reasonable notice, and the licensee may claim expenses incurred on a promise of continuance.

(C) The licence may not be revoked once money has been spent on the premises.

(D) Revocation requires an order of a court.

72. Which of the following facts would be most relevant to deciding whether an arrangement is a lease or a licence?

(A) Whether the arrangement was recorded in writing.

(B) Whether the occupier uses the premises for business or residence.

(C) Whether the occupier can exclude the owner and everyone else from the premises.

(D) Whether the occupier has paid a deposit.

XVI. Section 241 of the Companies Act, 2013 allows members of a company to apply to the National Company Law Tribunal where the affairs of the company have been conducted in a manner prejudicial to public interest or in a manner oppressive to any member or members, including a member or members to whom shares have been transmitted by operation of law. An application may be made by not less than one hundred members, or by members holding not less than one-tenth of the issued share capital, or by a member who has paid all calls and other sums due on his shares where the company has no share capital.

Where the Tribunal finds the application well founded, it may, with a view to bringing to an end the matters complained of, regulate the conduct of the company's affairs in future, purchase the shares of any member by the company or by other members, terminate or modify any agreement between the company and a managing director or manager, or remove a director and appoint another in his place.

The Tribunal is not to refuse relief on the ground that the applicant has an alternative remedy, and it may make interim orders pending the disposal of the application.

73. A shareholder holding eight per cent of the issued share capital, along with forty other shareholders holding a further five per cent between them, wishes to apply. Which of the following is correct?

(A) The application is not maintainable, since no single applicant holds one-tenth.
(B) Maintainability turns on the company having no share capital.
(C) The application is not maintainable, since one hundred members are required whatever the shareholding.
(D) The application is maintainable, since the applicants together hold more than one-tenth of the issued capital.

74. The majority shareholders have consistently excluded a minority shareholder from information and have caused the company to buy goods from a firm they own at above market prices. Which relief may the Tribunal grant?

(A) Regulation of the conduct of the company's affairs, and purchase of the minority's shares by the majority.
(B) Winding up of the company as the sole remedy.
(C) Criminal prosecution of the majority shareholders.
(D) Only compensation to the minority shareholder.

75. The respondents argue that the applicant should be refused relief because he could have sued for breach of a shareholders' agreement. Which of the following is correct?

(A) The objection fails, since the Tribunal is not to refuse relief on the ground that an alternative remedy exists.
(B) The objection succeeds where the agreement provides for arbitration.
(C) The objection is a matter for the Tribunal's discretion.
(D) The objection succeeds, since an alternative remedy bars an application.

76. The Tribunal is satisfied that the affairs of the company are being conducted oppressively but the hearing will take several months. Which of the following is correct?

(A) The Tribunal's power is confined to directing a reply.
(B) The Tribunal may make an interim order pending disposal of the application.
(C) The Tribunal is to await the final hearing before making an order.
(D) The Tribunal may order winding up as an interim measure.

XVII. Environmental regulation in India proceeds on two principles that the courts have treated as part of the law of the land. The precautionary principle requires that where there is a threat of serious or irreversible damage, a lack of full scientific certainty shall not be used as a reason for postponing measures to prevent environmental degradation. The polluter pays principle requires that the cost of preventing or remedying damage be borne by the person responsible for it, and it has been applied to require restitution of the environment as well as compensation to those affected.

Where an enterprise is engaged in a hazardous or inherently dangerous activity and harm results from an accident in the operation of that activity, the enterprise is absolutely and non-delegably liable to compensate those affected, and it is no answer that the enterprise had taken all reasonable care or that the harm was caused by the act of an employee.

The burden of proof that a proposed activity is environmentally safe lies on the person proposing it, and the regulatory authority may require an environmental audit, or may direct the closure of an activity and the restoration of the site at the cost of the operator.

77. A company proposes a chemical plant near a wetland and submits a study that says the risk to the wetland cannot be ruled out but that further research is needed. Which of the following is the most accurate statement?

(A) The absence of full scientific certainty does not justify postponing measures to prevent degradation.

(B) The plant may proceed if the company undertakes to fund the further research.

(C) The plant may proceed if the wetland lies outside its boundary.

(D) The plant may proceed, since the risk has not been established.

78. A leak at a pesticide plant injures residents despite the company showing that it had installed all equipment required by its licence and that an employee had ignored instructions. Which of the following is correct?

(A) The company is not liable, since the act was that of an employee.

(B) The company is absolutely liable to compensate those affected.

(C) The company's liability is confined to what the employee is unable to pay.

(D) The company is not liable, since it took reasonable care.

79. A regulator is unsure whether a proposed quarry will silt a river. Which of the following is correct?

(A) Refusal may follow completion of an environmental audit.

(B) The regulator may not act until a court decides the question.

(C) The burden lies on the regulator to prove that the quarry will cause harm.

(D) The person proposing the quarry must establish that it is environmentally safe.

80. The regulator directs a factory to close and to restore the site at its own cost. Which principle supports the direction?

(A) The burden of proof rule, because the operator is required to show the site is safe.

(B) The precautionary principle, because the factory may cause future harm.

(C) The polluter pays principle, because the cost of remedying damage is placed on the operator.

(D) Absolute liability, because the direction compensates affected residents.

XVIII. The Juvenile Justice (Care and Protection of Children) Act, 2015 treats a person below eighteen years as a child. A child alleged to have committed an offence is a "child in conflict with law", and is dealt with by a Juvenile Justice Board rather than by an ordinary court. "Heinous offence" means an offence for which the punishment under any law is imprisonment for seven years or more.

Where a child who has completed sixteen years is alleged to have committed a heinous offence, the Board may conduct a preliminary assessment of the child's mental and physical capacity to commit the offence, the child's ability to understand the consequences, and the circumstances in which the offence was allegedly committed, and may pass an order that the child be tried as an adult before a Children's Court. Such an assessment is not required where the alleged offence is not heinous. The Board must complete its inquiry within four months from the date of the first production of the child, and may extend the period by two months for reasons recorded in writing.

No child shall be subjected to the death penalty or to imprisonment for life without the possibility of release, and no child shall be handcuffed or chained while being taken to or from a court.

81. A child aged seventeen years and four months is alleged to have committed an offence punishable with ten years' imprisonment. Which of the following is correct?

(A) The Board is to try the child as an adult, since the offence is heinous.

(B) The Board may conduct a preliminary assessment and may order trial as an adult.

(C) The Board has no power to order trial as an adult in any circumstances.

(D) The case is transferred to the ordinary criminal court at once.

82. A child aged fifteen years is alleged to have committed the same offence. Which of the following is correct?

(A) The Board conducts a preliminary assessment.

(B) The Board is not required to conduct a preliminary assessment, since the child has not completed sixteen years.

(C) The Board may order trial as an adult if the offence is grave.

(D) The offence ceases to be heinous because of the child's age.

83. The Board has been unable to complete its inquiry within four months and has recorded no reasons for further time. Which of the following is the most accurate statement?

(A) The Board may extend the period by two months only for reasons recorded in writing.

(B) The Board may extend the period without limit.

(C) The inquiry is transferred to the Children's Court.

(D) The inquiry stands concluded in the child's favour.

84. A police officer handcuffs a child while transporting him to the Board, explaining that the child had attempted to escape earlier. Which of the following is correct?

(A) The action is permissible, since the child had attempted to escape.

(B) The action is contrary to the Act, which prohibits handcuffing or chaining a child.

(C) The action is permissible if the officer records the reason in writing.

(D) The action is permissible where the child is alleged to have committed a heinous offence.

LOGICAL REASONING (Q. 85 - 108)

XIX. That traffic noise is bad for the heart is now widely accepted, and the evidence behind the claim has a shape worth noticing. Most of it is cross-sectional: neighbourhoods near major roads are compared with quieter ones, and the residents of the former are found to have higher rates of hypertension. The difficulty is obvious once stated. Neighbourhoods near major roads are also, on average, poorer, less walkable, further from parks and closer to the emissions that come with the traffic. A correlation between noise and illness in such places is a correlation between several things and illness.

The studies that carry the most weight are the ones that exploit a change. When a city reroutes a highway, or closes an airport for a year, the noise in a set of streets changes while the streets do not. Residents do not become richer or poorer overnight, the shops do not move, and the air does not always improve in step. Where such natural experiments have been studied, blood pressure in the newly quiet streets has tended to fall, and in the newly noisy ones to rise.

This is a stronger design, but it is not a decisive one, and the reason is worth stating precisely. A rerouted highway changes more than decibels: it changes who drives past, at what hour, and how easily a resident can cross the road to reach the other side of the neighbourhood. The studies that control for these factors find smaller effects than the studies that do not, which is what one would expect if part of the original effect was never about sound at all.

None of this is an argument for ignoring noise. It is an argument about what kind of claim the evidence supports. That chronic noise is a stressor with physiological consequences is well established in laboratory work; that a given reduction in roadside noise will produce a given reduction in heart disease in a given city is a much larger claim, and it is the one that gets made whenever a council proposes a barrier and a budget.

85. What advantage does the author attribute to studies that exploit a change such as a rerouted highway?

(A) They include residents who would not agree to take part in a survey.

(B) They establish the physiological mechanism by which noise acts on the heart.

(C) They measure noise more accurately than surveys of residents do.

(D) They hold constant the characteristics of the neighbourhoods while the exposure changes.

86. Which of the following can be inferred from the passage?

(A) Cross-sectional studies of noise are of no value to researchers.

(B) Air pollution is a more important cause of hypertension than noise is.

(C) Rerouted highways reduce noise in the streets they leave behind.

(D) The effect of noise estimated by cross-sectional studies is likely to be larger than the effect estimated by natural experiments.

87. Which of the following, if true, would most weaken the author's argument?

(A) In cities where highways were rerouted, blood pressure fell by the same amount in streets where air quality was unchanged and in streets where it improved.

(B) Some residents of noisy streets report sleep disturbance that they attribute to traffic.

(C) Roadside noise barriers are expensive to install and maintain.

(D) Laboratory studies show that sustained noise raises stress hormones in human subjects.

88. The sentence about a council proposing a barrier and a budget serves to:

(A) identify the practical decision on which the author's distinction bears.

(B) criticise councils for spending money on noise barriers.

(C) concede that the author's argument has no policy relevance.

(D) introduce evidence that barriers do not reduce heart disease.

89. The author's conclusion depends on the assumption that:

(A) residents of noisy streets are unable to move away.

(B) laboratory findings about stress hormones are relevant to chronic exposure in cities.

(C) the factors that change alongside a rerouted highway can be measured and separated from noise.

(D) heart disease rates in a city respond to changes within a few years.

90. A councillor argues: 'Noise barriers have not been shown to reduce heart disease, so we should not build them.' Which of the following most accurately describes the weakness in that argument?

(A) It confuses the cost of a measure with its effectiveness.

(B) It treats the absence of evidence for one benefit as evidence that the measure has no benefit at all.

(C) It assumes that councils are obliged to spend money on public health.

(D) It must ignore the possibility that barriers are popular with residents.

XX. Irrigation in most Indian states is priced in a way that no economist would defend and no politician wishes to change. Farmers pay a flat charge, or nothing, for water; the electricity that lifts it is often free; and the result is that the marginal cost of the last unit of water to the farmer is close to zero. Water-intensive crops are then grown where they should not be, aquifers are drawn down, and the state pays twice - once for the power and once for the wells that must be sunk deeper.

The standard remedy is volumetric pricing: meter the water, charge by the unit, and let the price do the allocating. The objection is not that farmers would refuse to pay. It is that the thing being priced is largely unmeasured. A canal can be metered at an outlet, but a tube well cannot be metered at the aquifer, and the meters that exist are frequently bypassed, tampered with or simply not read. A price that cannot be enforced is not a price; it is a suggestion.

The remedy that has worked where it has been tried is one step removed from the water. Charge for the electricity, on a schedule that rises with consumption rather than falling, and let the farmer decide how to respond. The attraction is administrative rather than theoretical: electricity is already metered, already billed, and already connected to a supply that can be curtailed. The farmer keeps the choice, the state keeps the revenue, and the incentive to waste the last unit disappears without anyone having to measure the water.

There is a distributional catch, and it is the reason the reform stalls. A flat charge for power is, in effect, a subsidy paid per connection, and its abolition raises the cost of pumping for every farmer, including the ones with a hectare and a single well. The gains accrue to the aquifer, which is shared, and the losses accrue to the smallest farmer, who is not. Any government that introduces the reform without a compensating transfer is asking the poorest cultivators to finance a common resource, and will discover within one season how quickly that becomes a political fact.

91. The author's main point is that:

(A) flat charges for irrigation water are the principal cause of rural poverty.

(B) aquifers lie beyond the reach of pricing instruments.

(C) water should be priced volumetrically across states.

(D) pricing electricity, with compensation, is a more workable route than metering water.

92. The claim that 'a price that cannot be enforced is not a price; it is a suggestion' is used to:

(A) argue that farmers are dishonest.

(B) propose that meters be installed more quickly.

(C) compare water pricing with other forms of taxation.

(D) dismiss volumetric pricing as impracticable in the conditions described.

93. Which of the following, if true, would most weaken the author's preferred remedy?

(A) Farmers with large holdings consume most of the electricity used for pumping.

(B) Electricity supply to agriculture is unmetered in the states where groundwater depletion is fastest.

(C) Rising block tariffs for electricity have reduced pumping in several districts.

(D) Compensating transfers are difficult to target at the smallest farmers.

94. The 'distributional catch' described in the last paragraph is that:

(A) the benefit of the reform is shared while its cost falls on those least able to bear it.

(B) farmers with large holdings will pay more than they do now.

(C) the state will lose revenue from electricity sales.

(D) aquifers recover more slowly than the reform assumes.

95. Which of the following is the author most likely to support?

(A) Abolishing all charges for agricultural electricity and funding conservation from general taxation.

(B) Raising the price of electricity for pumping while paying a direct transfer to small cultivators.

(C) Metering tube wells before any change is made to electricity tariffs.

(D) Leaving the present arrangement in place until the aquifer data improve.

96. The argument in the passage would be most strengthened by evidence that:

(A) canal irrigation is metered successfully in some command areas.

(B) block tariffs for agricultural power have reduced pumping without reducing yields in a neighbouring state.

(C) groundwater levels have fallen across the districts of the state.

(D) farmers prefer flat charges because they are predictable.

XXI. The promise of regenerative agriculture is that soil can be made to hold more carbon, and that the holding can be paid for. Both halves of that sentence carry more weight than the phrase 'carbon farming' is usually asked to bear.

The measurement problem comes first. Soil carbon varies enormously across a field, and the variation is not random: it follows drainage, slope and the history of what was grown there. To know whether a practice has added carbon, one must sample before and after, at enough points to see past that variation, and the sampling itself disturbs the soil. Estimates built on models rather than samples are cheaper and are, for that reason, what most schemes use, which means that the quantity being paid for is frequently an inference rather than a measurement.

The additionality problem comes second. A payment is supposed to reward a change of practice, but many of the practices in question - less tillage, cover crops, manure instead of fertiliser - are things a farmer might have done anyway, or might do for three years and then abandon when the payment ends. A scheme that pays for what would have happened regardless transfers money without changing the atmosphere.

The permanence problem comes third and is the least tractable. Carbon in soil is not stored in a vault; it is held in a cycle, and a change of land use, a dry decade or a single deep ploughing can release in a season what took years to accumulate. A contract that pays for storage over twenty years is therefore a contract about a physical process that no party to it controls.

None of this means the practice is worthless. Soils that hold more carbon tend to hold more water, and farms that hold more water are more resilient in exactly the seasons when resilience is worth most. The case for paying farmers to farm better is a good case. It is a different case from the one made in carbon markets, and the difference is what happens when the measurement is contested, the practice was already happening, and the weather changes.

97. The author's attitude to payments for soil carbon is best described as:

(A) indifferent, since the amounts involved are small.

(B) opposed, because the practices do not work.

(C) sceptical of the way the payments are justified, while accepting the practices have value.

(D) supportive, because measurement problems can be solved by better models.

98. The three problems are presented in an order that:

(A) follows the sequence in which a farmer would encounter them.

(B) reflects the importance the author attaches to each, least first.

(C) moves from the difficulty that can be fixed by more sampling to the one that cannot be fixed by any party.

(D) moves from the most expensive problem to the least expensive.

99. Which of the following, if true, would most weaken the author's additionality argument?

(A) Most farmers who adopt cover crops continue with them after payments end.

(B) Cover crops reduce yields in the first two seasons.

(C) Payments for cover crops are small relative to farm incomes.

(D) Some farmers adopt cover crops for reasons unrelated to payment.

100. The claim that a twenty-year storage contract is 'a contract about a physical process that no party to it controls' implies that:

(A) twenty years is longer than the life of most farms.

(B) such contracts should not be written at all.

(C) the risk of reversal cannot be allocated by agreement among the parties.

(D) farmers are unable to influence soil carbon at all.

101. Which of the following principles is consistent with the author's position?

(A) Farmers should be paid for practices that are easy to verify.

(B) Public money should not be spent on agricultural practices.

(C) A payment should be justified by the outcome it is said to buy rather than by the activity it rewards.

(D) Where measurement is difficult, payment must be avoided.

102. The final sentence suggests that the difference between the two cases matters most:

(A) when governments change.

(B) when the claims made for a scheme are tested against what can be shown.

(C) when farmers refuse to sign contracts.

(D) when the price of carbon rises.

XXII. Welfare departments increasingly use statistical models to decide who should be investigated for overpayment, which applications need a second look, and which households should be visited first. The case for this is straightforward: caseworkers cannot examine everyone, and a model that ranks cases by risk allocates scarce attention better than a queue ordered by date of arrival.

The objection that gets made most often is that the models are opaque, and it is usually answered by pointing out that the human decisions they replace were opaque too. A caseworker's hunch cannot be inspected, cannot be reproduced, and cannot be appealed against in any meaningful sense. A model's output can at least be described. That answer is correct as far as it goes, and it goes less far than its users suppose.

The reason is that a model does not replace a hunch with an explanation. It replaces one hunch with a very large number of small ones, each embedded in a variable chosen by an analyst and weighted by a procedure. What a department can describe is the input and the output; what it cannot usually describe is why this household scored what it scored, in terms a caseworker or a tribunal could examine. The opacity has moved rather than gone.

There is a second and less discussed consequence. A model trained on past decisions learns the pattern of those decisions, including whatever biases produced them, and it applies the pattern consistently. Consistency is a virtue in a queue and something else in an investigation, because a biased rule applied consistently produces more unequal outcomes than the same bias applied unevenly. The department that adopts a model for fairness may find that it has industrialised the unfairness it meant to remove.

None of this argues for returning to hunches. It argues for a specific discipline: a model used to allocate attention should be accompanied by a route by which a household can contest the allocation, and that route should not require the household to understand the model. The right to an explanation, in other words, is not a right to the algorithm. It is a right to a decision that someone can be asked about.

103. The author's view of the claim that a model's output can be described is that it is:

(A) false, since models resist description.

(B) true but insufficient, since description of input and output is not an explanation of a decision.

(C) decisive, since describability is what makes a decision fair.

(D) irrelevant, since caseworkers' hunches were equally opaque.

104. The claim that a model replaces one hunch with many small ones is used to explain:

(A) why the opacity of decisions has been relocated rather than removed.

(B) why analysts are responsible for unfair outcomes.

(C) why caseworkers resist the introduction of models.

(D) why models are more accurate than caseworkers.

105. Which of the following, if true, would most weaken the author's argument about consistency?

(A) Models are retrained annually on new data.

(B) Models trained on past decisions reproduce the pattern of those decisions.

(C) Where models were introduced, the disparity in investigation rates between two otherwise similar groups fell.

(D) Caseworkers have been known to investigate households on personal dislike.

106. The right the author recommends is best described as:

(A) a right to see the weights assigned to each variable.

(B) a right to have the decision accounted for by a person who can be questioned.

(C) a right to refuse to be assessed by a model in every case.

(D) a right to compensation where a model is wrong.

107. The author's argument depends on the assumption that:

(A) caseworkers are more biased than models.

(B) welfare departments have the capacity to build accurate models.

(C) households will use a contest route if one is provided.

(D) a contest route can function without the household understanding the model.

108. Which of the following most closely parallels the author's point about industrialising unfairness?

(A) A hospital that buys better equipment treats more patients than one that does not.

(B) A firm that automates payroll makes fewer arithmetic errors than one that does not.

(C) A city that installs more cameras detects more offences than one that does not.

(D) A school that replaces individual marking with a single national examination standardises whatever bias the examination contains.

QUANTITATIVE TECHNIQUES (Q. 109 - 120)

XXIII. A housing survey of 4,000 households in a district classified each household by tenure. Forty-five per cent of the households were owner-occupied, thirty per cent were rented, and the remaining households were in other arrangements, such as accommodation provided by an employer. Two-fifths of the rented households were rent-controlled.

The average monthly rent paid by a rented household was Rs. 8,000. The average imputed monthly value of an owner-occupied dwelling was Rs. 3,000, this being an estimate of what the dwelling would fetch if rented rather than a sum actually paid.

In the following year the survey was repeated. Average rents had risen by fifteen per cent, and the number of rented households had risen by ten per cent, while the number of owner-occupied and other households was unchanged.

[Illustrative data compiled for this paper.]

109. What is the ratio of rented households to owner-occupied households?

(A) 2 : 3

(B) 3 : 2

(C) 3 : 4

(D) 2 : 5

110. Rent-controlled households form what percentage of all households surveyed?

(A) 15 per cent

(B) 30 per cent

(C) 8 per cent

(D) 12 per cent

111. The average rent of a rented household exceeds the imputed value of an owner-occupied dwelling by:

(A) about 37.5 per cent

(B) about 62.5 per cent

(C) about 166.7 per cent

(D) about 267 per cent

112. In the second year, what was the percentage change in the total rent paid by all rented households?

(A) 25 per cent

(B) 26.5 per cent

(C) 32.5 per cent

(D) 15 per cent

XXIV. A trader in a wholesale market marks up every article by a fixed percentage on its cost price and then allows a trade discount on the marked price. Her ledger records, for each article sold, the cost price, the marked price, the discount allowed and the net selling price.

In one week she sold four lots. The first lot was marked at forty per cent above cost and sold at a discount of twenty-five per cent on the marked price. The second was marked at Rs. 1,200 and carried two successive discounts, of twenty-five per cent and then twenty per cent on the reduced price. The third lot consisted of five consignments whose average value was Rs. 42 each; one consignment worth Rs. 30 was returned by the buyer, and two new consignments were added, after which the average value of the six consignments was Rs. 45.

The fourth lot was a blend: twenty kilograms of a commodity bought at Rs. 30 per kilogram were mixed with thirty kilograms of the same commodity bought at Rs. 45 per kilogram, and the whole was sold at Rs. 42 per kilogram.

[Illustrative data compiled for this paper.]

113. What was the profit percentage on the first lot?

(A) 10 per cent
(B) 15 per cent
(C) 25 per cent
(D) 5 per cent

114. What was the net selling price of the second lot?

(A) Rs. 660
(B) Rs. 720
(C) Rs. 750
(D) Rs. 900

115. What was the average value of the two new consignments added to the third lot?

(A) Rs. 60
(B) Rs. 40
(C) Rs. 45
(D) Rs. 52

116. What was the profit percentage on the blended fourth lot?

(A) about 7.7 per cent
(B) about 5 per cent
(C) about 12 per cent
(D) about 16.7 per cent

XXV. A grocer stocks two grades of tea, one at Rs. 180 per kilogram and the other at Rs. 240 per kilogram, and sells a blend at Rs. 200 per kilogram. The blending is done so that the cost of the blend is exactly recovered by the selling price, with no profit or loss on the blend itself.

In the same week the grocer took stock of a class of provisions. Thirty packets had an average weight of 62 grams. Five packets with an average weight of 50 grams were sold and removed from the shelf. Separately, a committee of eight persons had an average age of 45 years; one member aged 60 years left and was replaced by a member aged 36 years.

A vessel used for testing held 60 litres of milk. Twelve litres were drawn off and replaced with water, and the operation was then repeated once: twelve litres of the mixture were drawn off and replaced with water.

[Illustrative data compiled for this paper.]

117. In what ratio must the two grades of tea be blended?

(A) 2 : 1
(B) 3 : 2
(C) 2 : 3
(D) 1 : 2

118. What is the average weight of the packets remaining on the shelf?

(A) 64 grams
(B) 64.4 grams

(C) 66 grams
(D) 63.2 grams

119. What is the average age of the committee after the replacement?
(A) 43 years
(B) 44 years
(C) 41 years
(D) 42 years

120. How much milk remains in the vessel after the two operations?
(A) 38.4 litres
(B) 40 litres
(C) 43.2 litres
(D) 36 litres

SPACE FOR ROUGH WORK

ANSWER KEY

One mark for a correct answer, a deduction of one-quarter mark for a wrong answer, and nothing for a question left unattempted.

Q	A	Q	A	Q	A	Q	A	Q	A
1	B	2	A	3	A	4	D	5	C
6	A	7	D	8	C	9	C	10	D
11	D	12	A	13	C	14	D	15	C
16	B	17	D	18	B	19	A	20	D
21	C	22	C	23	D	24	C	25	A
26	C	27	C	28	D	29	C	30	B
31	B	32	A	33	B	34	D	35	A
36	D	37	B	38	C	39	D	40	B
41	D	42	B	43	D	44	C	45	A
46	C	47	A	48	D	49	A	50	B
51	C	52	A	53	D	54	C	55	C
56	B	57	C	58	C	59	D	60	A
61	A	62	B	63	A	64	D	65	A
66	B	67	B	68	D	69	A	70	C
71	B	72	C	73	D	74	A	75	A
76	B	77	A	78	B	79	D	80	C
81	B	82	B	83	A	84	B	85	D
86	D	87	A	88	A	89	C	90	B
91	D	92	D	93	B	94	A	95	B
96	B	97	C	98	C	99	A	100	C
101	C	102	B	103	B	104	A	105	C
106	B	107	D	108	D	109	A	110	D
111	C	112	B	113	D	114	B	115	C
116	A	117	A	118	B	119	D	120	A

Scoring	Your count	Marks
Correct answers		x 1
Wrong answers		x -0.25
Net score out of 120		